Of course, I wondered at first if this wasn't a setup and if the fellows who were pushing me to run for governor hadn't planted these people in the audience. But pretty soon I realized it was happening too often in too many places to be a setup; these were people with no special interest in politics.

After about three months of this, I returned home one night and said to Nancy, "This isn't working out the way I thought it would. You know, these guys may be right. All these people are telling me after my speeches that I ought to run for governor; this may end up putting us in an awful spot."

Then I'd go out back on the road and give another speech and hear the same things again and I'd come home and Nancy and I would talk about it again. Before long, we were having trouble getting to sleep again; we'd lay in bed and say, "Will we ever be able to live with ourselves if we turn our backs on this and Pat Brown wins a third term?"

When the six months were almost over, I asked her: "How do you say no to all these people?"

If I decided to run, we agreed our life we knew and loved would change dramatically, perhaps forever. But I told Nancy: "I don't think we can run away from it." She agreed.

I called the people who were pressing me to run against Brown and said, "Okay, I'll do it," and on a television broadcast January 4, 1966, I announced my intention to seek the Republican nomination for governor.